



Policy for Promotion of Research

**Approved by the Fifty-Ninth Meeting of the Academic Council of NIIT
University, Neemrana, held on Friday, July 24, 2026**

NIIT University reserves the right to modify the policy as deemed fit from time to time

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NIIT University Policy for Promotion of Research

Proposed by	Reviewed by	Approved by	Date of AC Approval
Dean Research Office (Dr Neha Tiwari)	RAC Members: Dr. Shivendra Mathur Prof. Debashis Sengupta Dr. Sanjeev Kumar Dr. Vikas Upadhyaya Dr. Ganapathirao Maradana Prof. Ritu Dangwal Leadership Team: Prof. Parimal Mandke Prof. Vandana Suhag	Academic Council	24 th July 2026



Signature of Registrar
(Prof. Shivendra Mathur)

Date: 27/8/2026

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1. Preamble

Research-driven education is one of the four core principles of NIIT University (NU), fundamentally aimed at igniting students' curiosity and spurring a lifelong quest for knowledge. To this end, NU integrates research-based curricula with extensive project opportunities that extend beyond the formal syllabus. These research initiatives commence in the first year of every undergraduate programme, regardless of discipline, ensuring that students internalize a research mindset early in their academic journey. By applying project-based learning to everyday living situations, NU transforms every student activity into a potential research project.

This integrative experience—spanning curriculum, community, enquiry, and self-learning—fosters a transformational change in a student's ability to conduct rigorous investigation. Consequently, the University has promulgated this policy to promote both a "research temper" and a "research career," establishing benchmark standards for the quality of all research carried out at NU. In alignment with the Vision, Mission, and Core Principles of the University, this policy is designed to enhance innovation capabilities and research activities. The University expects its various Academic Areas to remain focused in their efforts by identifying select thrust fields that are commensurate with the strategic Vision and Mission of NU.

2. Objectives

- To inculcate a research temper and promote research activities among faculty, staff and students.
- To improve the quality and relevance of research at NU.
- To nurture industry-oriented and socially relevant research.
- To generate IP by way of patents and scientific publications.
- To establish the practice of collaborative research between NU and other Universities.

3. Research Advisory Committee (RAC)

Research Advisory Committee will actively work towards promoting and facilitating research activities in the university. The responsibilities of the committee will be but not limited to

- a. Assess and recommend projects to external funding agencies for support.
- b. Recommend proposals under various NU schemes such as NUIG, NUCOS, NURAP for support.
- c. Frame list of best practices and ethical guidelines for conducting research and disseminating results.



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- d. Relaxing the condition of number of publications for recognition of a person as Research Supervisor with reasons, recorded in writing, in areas/disciplines where there is no, or only a limited number of peer-reviewed or refereed journals.
- e. Approving Co-Supervisors from other institutions for students enrolled in PhD programme.
- f. To approve the change in the area of research, title of the thesis, locale and Supervisor.
- g. Actively seek and facilitate research collaboration with other universities, government and industry bodies.
- h. Any other as assigned by Academic Council.

3.1 Formulation of RAC:

Dean Research	Chairperson
All Area Directors	Member
Associate Dean of Research	Member

The faculty members may be invited to the RAC Meeting, as and when required as invitee, depending on the nature and requirements of the research under consideration.

4. Monetary Incentives for Authors

NU encourages the publication of journal articles, papers by the faculty and collaborative research within and outside the university. University also provides monetary incentives to faculty members on rolls and registered students to strengthen and promote research publication quality according to the following guidelines:

- a) Authors will maintain the highest standard of academic integrity and follow guidelines for similarity checks and AI-generated content as per NU Policy.
- b) Eligibility for the research incentive program is restricted to patents, copyrights, book chapters, books, extramural funding, journals and conference publications that meet the university's indexing requirements/norms as stated in the policy.
- c) Duration of incentive cycle is from August 1st of the previous year and July 31st of the year concerned to synchronize with the academic calendar.
- d) Faculty members on rolls and registered students of degree and PG Diploma programmes at the university till the end date of the relevant cycle are eligible for monetary incentive. Faculty members will receive their earned monetary incentives at the end of the academic year, even if they leave the university before the cycle concludes, in recognition of their research contributions as per the modification made on January 25th, 2025 in the NIIT University Policy of Promotion of Research (2023).
- e) Affiliation with NU should be clearly visible in the published work to be considered for a monetary incentive.
- f) The incentive amount for joint authorship shall be equally distributed among the eligible authors from the NIIT University.
- g) The amount of monetary incentive will be as per a given list that will be communicated to the faculty members and students before the start of the incentive cycle i.e., before August 1st of the year concerned.

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- h) Maximum incentive amount is INR 2,00,000/- only (two lakhs only) per cycle for faculty members and INR 45,000/- only (forty-five thousand only) for students.
- i) Authors must apply in a prescribed form available with the Research Office along with soft copy of the work to be eligible for the monetary incentive.
- j) Faculty members serving their probationary period remain fully eligible for research incentives earned through their scholarly outputs; however, while the entitlement is recorded during probation, the actual disbursement of these incentives will be deferred and processed during the subsequent academic cycle following the successful completion of their probationary period and formal confirmation of service.

4.1 Details of monetary incentive for faculty members on rolls:

S. No.	Journals/Conference Papers	Reward Amount (INR)
1	Article in Q1 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (A*) indexed Journals	60,000/-
2	Article in Q2 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (A) indexed Journals	50,000/-
3	Article in Q3 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (B) indexed Journals	35,000/-
4	Article in Q4 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (C) indexed Journals	25,000/-
5	Article in SCOPUS/ESCI-indexed Q1 Journals	35,000/-
6	Article in SCOPUS/ESCI-indexed Q2 Journals	30,000/-
7	Article in SCOPUS/ESCI-indexed Q3 Journals	25,000/-
8	Article in SCOPUS/ESCI-indexed Q4 Journals	20,000/-
9	Articles indexed in ESCI without quartile assignment	20,000/-
10	Article in PubMed-indexed Journals	15,000/-
11	Authored book indexed in BKCI-S, BKCI-SSH, having ISBN/ISSN	30,000/-
12	Edited book indexed in BKCI-S, BKCI-SSH having ISBN/ISSN	15,000/-
13	Book chapter in book indexed in BKCI-S, BKCI-SSH having ISBN/ISSN	10,000/-
14	Authored book having ISBN/ISSN	10,000/-
15	Book chapter in book having ISBN/ISSN	5,000/-
16	Student Faculty Joint Publication (With Faculty mentors as the last author) in Conference Proceedings indexed in EI/CPCI-S/CPCI-SSH /IEEE/ACM/SCOPUS/ WoS	5,000/-
17	Patent (Utility) Granted by Indian Patent Office	30,000/-

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18	Patent (Design) Granted by Indian Patent Office	20,000/-
19	Copyright Registered with Copyright Office, Government of India	10,000/-

Here,

Q1: First quartile

Q2: Second quartile

Q3: Third quartile

Q4: Fourth quartile

SCI: Science Citation Index

SCIE: Science Citation Index Expanded

SSCI: Social Sciences Citation Index

AHCI: Arts and Humanities Citation Index

ESCI: Emerging Source Citation Index

BKCI-S: Book Citation Index-Science

BKCI-SSH: Book Citation Index-Social Sciences and Humanities

CPCI-S: Conference Proceedings Citation Index-Science

CPCI-SSH: Conference Proceedings Citation Index-Social Sciences and Humanities

ACM: Association for Computing Machinery

ABDC: Australian Business Deans Council.

- All the indices will be checked with Clarivate Analytics/Web of Science (WoS) Core Collection/SCOPUS/ICI by the Librarian. A parallel committee constituted by the Dean of Research will check and vet the publication list before forwarding it for further deliberation.
- The quartiles Q1, Q2, Q3 and Q4 in SCI/SCIE/SSCI/AHCI indexed journals will be taken from Journal Citation reports (JCR) given by Clarivate Analytics or Scimago as per the research area and the date of publication concerned. Higher of the quartile values as given by Clarivate Analytics and Scimago will be considered. If the same journal has multiple categories and these categories fall under different quartiles, the reward amount will be based on the category to which the publications belong.
- A weighted mix of publications across quartiles where:
At least 50% of the total eligible incentive value arises from Q1 and/or Q2 publications, and The incentive claim is not derived entirely from Q3 or entirely from Q4 publications.
Publications exclusively in Q3 and/or Q4 indexed journals shall remain eligible for monetary incentives as per prescribed rates; however, such publications alone shall qualify only up to a maximum cumulative incentive of INR 1,40,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Forty Thousand only) per cycle.

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4.2 Details of monetary incentives for students per publication:

S. No.	Journals/Conference Papers	Reward Amount (INR)
1	Article in Q1 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (A*) indexed Journals	15,000/-
2	Article in Q2 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (A) indexed Journals	10,000/-
3	Article in Q3 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (B) indexed Journals	5,000/-
4	Article in Q4 SCI/SSCI/SCIE/AHCI/ABDC (C) indexed Journals	2,000/-
5	Article in ESCI/ SCOPUS/PUBMED-indexed Journals	1,000/-
6	Patent (Utility) Granted by the Indian Patent Office	5,000/-
7	Patent (Design) Granted by the Indian Patent Office	3,000/-
8	Copyright Registered with Copyright Office, Government of India	3,000/-

Maximum incentive amount is INR 45000/- only (forty-five thousand only) per student

4.3 Procedure

- Authors will inform the Research Office within one week of the work getting published and submit a soft copy to the Research Office. This is to help the Research Office to verify the publication and start preparing the proposal for the incentive even before the cycle ends on July 31st.
- Authors will apply for the incentive in a prescribed form available with the Research Office by the end of the first week of August. Soft copies of the works should also be provided to the Research Office.
- The research office will propose the incentive and share it with authors latest by the end of the third week of August. Authors should make a representation in writing to the Research Office in case of any dispute. The Research Office must resolve the dispute by the end of the fourth week of August. The matter may be presented to the Research Committee if required. The decision of the Research Committee will be final and binding for all.

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5. Participation in National and International Conferences – Frequency and Financial Caps

5.1 Objective:

The University encourages faculty participation in reputed national and international conferences for the dissemination of research, academic engagement, and professional development, subject to financial discipline and equitable access.

5.2 Eligibility:

Faculty members on rolls with at least 12 months of continuous service at the time of application may apply, provided the conference proceedings are indexed in SCOPUS/ WoS/ IEEE /ACM. Financial support is distributed based on authorship.

5.2.1 Internal Collaborations: If all authors are university faculty, any one member may claim the support.

5.2.2 Student Collaborations: If co-authors are NU students, the first-author student is eligible for support under the NUTAP student policy.

5.2.3 External Collaborations: If co-authors are not affiliated with NU, the faculty member must be the first author to receive support.

5.3 Frequency of Support:

5.3.1 International Conferences (outside India):

Financial support shall be limited to one international conference in a block of two academic years, subject to the availability of funds and prior support availed.

5.3.2 National Conferences / International Conferences within India.

Support may be considered up to two conferences per academic year, based on merit and availability of funds.

5.4 Financial Cap per Instance:

The maximum reimbursement for participation in any conference—National or International—shall be capped at INR 1,75,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Seventy Five Thousand) per instance for International Conference and INR 50,000/- (Rupees Fifty Thousand) per instance for National Conference.

This cap shall include registration fee, travel, accommodation, per diem, visa fee (if applicable), and local conveyance, as per NIIT University norms.

Any expenditure beyond the approved cap shall be borne by the faculty member.

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5.5 Conditions of Support:

5.5.1 Only one author per paper (Faculty/Student) shall be eligible for financial support.

5.5.2 Preference may be given to faculty members who have not availed conference support in the preceding two cycles, to ensure equitable distribution.

5.6 Approval and Reimbursement:

5.6.1 All support shall be subject to prior approval of the Research Advisory Committee.

5.6.2 Reimbursement shall be made strictly against original bills and vouchers, within the approved cap.

5.6.3 The decision of the Research Committee shall be final and binding.

5.7 Exception Clause

Any exception to the frequency restriction may be considered only in exceptional academic circumstances (e.g., plenary or keynote invitations), with explicit approval of the Research Committee; however, the financial cap of INR 1,75,000 per instance (International) and INR 50,000 per instance (national) shall not be exceeded under any circumstances.

Faculty members who are serving their notice period or are on sabbatical shall not be eligible to avail financial support from the University for attending conferences.

5.8 Procedure for Application

5.8.1 The application along with the letter of acceptance of the paper from the organizers of conference should be sent 45 days prior to the commencement of the conference, through the Area Director to Dean Research for presenting to the Research Advisory Committee.

5.8.2 If the paper is co-authored, then a no-objection certificate(s) from the author(s) may be attached with the application. In case of two or more applications for the same paper(s) only one application will be considered, and priority will be given to the first author.

5.9 Procedure for Reimbursement/Advance

5.9.1 The faculty member must fill in the reimbursement/advance form as provided by Dean Research Office. The NUTAP approval of Research Committee along with the conference participation certificate should be attached with form.

5.8.3 Attach all bills including tickets and submit the filled form to Research Office within one month of attending the conference for reimbursement or settling the advance.

5.8.4 Research Office will verify the claim and approve reimbursement or settlement.

5.8.5 The matter will be presented to the Research Committee in case of any dispute. The decision of the Research Committee will be final and binding to all.

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6. NIIT University Travel Assistance Program (NUTAP)

This program is to encourage participation of students in national and international conferences by providing monetary incentives to students provided the conference proceedings are indexed in SCOPUS/WoS/IEEE/ ACM, as per the following guidelines:

- Registered students at the university at the time of the conference are eligible for monetary incentive.
- Students will maintain highest standard of academic integrity and follow guidelines for similarity checks and AI generated content as per NU Policy.
- Duration of incentive cycle is from August 1st of the previous year and July 31st of the year concerned.
- NIIT University offers maximum financial support up to INR 15,000/- only (Fifteen thousand only) for National and up to INR 50,000/- only (Fifty thousand only) for International Conference participation for each research paper/poster. The sponsorship would cover part or whole of the registration fee, travel (economy class air fare by the shortest route for international conferences or AC III train fare for national conferences) plus local transportation, per diem allowance and visa fees (for international travel) as per existing rules duly supported by vouchers.
- Required leave will be granted to cover the duration of the conference along with one day before the start and one day after the end of the conference subject to a maximum of six days. Leave will be granted by Dean Academics on the recommendations of the Dean Research.
- Only one author per paper/poster will be considered for support.
- Financial support shall be limited to one national and one international conference (held outside India) in an academic year, subject to availability of funds and prior support availed.
- Preference will be given to students who have a CGPA greater than 7.5, have not been supported in the past and who secure partial support from other funding sources like IARCS, Microsoft Research, DST, DIT, etc. which give support to students for travel to conferences.
- Final decision to support will be taken by the President based on the recommendations from Dean Research.

6.1 Procedure for Application

- 6.1.1** The application along with the letter of acceptance of the paper from the organizers of conference should be sent 30 days prior to the commencement of the conference, through the Area Director to Dean Research for presenting to the Research Committee. If the paper does not have a faculty co-author, an endorsement by a faculty member needs to be enclosed.

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- 6.1.2** If the paper is co-authored, then a no-objection certificate(s) from the author(s) may be attached with the application. In case of two or more applications for the same paper(s) only one application will be considered, and priority will be given to the first author.

6.2 Procedure for Reimbursement

- 6.2.1** The students must fill in the reimbursement form as provided by Dean Research Office. The NUTAP approval of Research Committee, along with the conference participation certificate, should be attached with form.
- 6.2.2** Attach all bills, including tickets and submit the filled form to Research Office within one month of attending the conference.
- 6.2.3** Research Office will verify the claim and approve reimbursement.
- 6.2.4** The matter will be presented to the Research Committee in case of any dispute. The decision of the Research Committee will be final and binding to all.

7. NIIT University Research Assistantship Programme (NURAP):

The NU Research Assistantship Programme (NURAP) is designed to engage the students more deeply in the research life of the University. The Programme therefore provides opportunities to work with faculty to carry out innovative research and to vigorously pursue the applications that flow from it. The students will work very closely with and be mentored by faculty researchers to enhance their skills in areas of their interest. The aim is to develop innovative solutions to the most daunting challenges by engaging in frontline research at the frontiers of modern technology. NU will provide an assistantship of INR 5,000 only (five thousand only) per month for two months to the students selected under NURAP. Further, the hostel fee would be borne by NU for two months (June & July of the academic year concerned). The recipients are expected to submit a research paper within three months after the completion of two months of NURAP.

7.1 Procedure for application:

Faculties interested in mentoring students in NURAP must submit a list of projects with the prerequisites. For financial assistance, students should be categorized into two stages. In stage one, the student will be under observation for a certain period to see whether s/he is able to understand the project and have interest and ability to do it. Here students need to show some progress in the initial development of the project including learning the prerequisites for the project. In stage two, the student will get a fellowship based on his/her monthly performance certified by the faculty mentor.

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8. NIIT University Ignition Grant (NUIG)

The NUIG scheme is to provide financial assistance to the newly joined faculty members on rolls of the university to enable a quick start to their research program as per the following guidelines:

- 8.1 Eligibility:** Open to on-roll Assistant, Associate, or Professors with less than 3 years of service at NU who hold a Ph.D. and have 2–3 publications in Scopus/WoS. Those with major external funding or prior ignition grants are ineligible.
- 8.2 Funding & Duration:** Maximum funding of INR 2,00,000 per faculty member (can increase for joint proposals). Projects must be completed within 24 months, with a possible 1-year extension.
- 8.3 Deliverables:** Recipients must submit periodic progress reports (every 6 months) and are expected to publish research papers in Scopus/WoS indexed journals, duly acknowledging the University's contribution and seeking external funding.

9. NIIT University Conference Organization Support (NUCOS)

NUCOS is a scheme designed to provide partial financial support to individual academic areas, or a group of academic areas, for organizing academic events such as conferences (national or international), symposiums, workshops, and similar scholarly activities. The objective of the scheme is to facilitate meaningful interaction between researchers from NU and distinguished national and international researchers, thereby strengthening academic collaboration, knowledge exchange, and research visibility of the University.

Under this scheme:

- a) A maximum financial support of INR 2,00,000 (Rupees Two Lakhs only) may be provided for organizing an international conference. For the purpose of this scheme, an international conference shall be defined as a conference in which participants or speakers from at least three to five different countries are represented.
- b) A maximum financial support of INR 1,00,000 (Rupees One Lakh only) may be provided for organizing a national conference.

The approval and quantum of financial support under NUCOS shall be determined by the NU Research Advisory Committee (RAC) based on the merit, relevance, and expected academic impact of the proposed event.

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10. Special Doctoral Supervision Initiative:

Eligible on-roll faculty Ph.D. supervisors may now participate in a special drive, allowing for the enrollment of one non-residential Ph.D. scholar per academic year at a significantly reduced fee of INR 16,000/- (Rs. Sixteen Thousand only) per semester, up to a maximum of three at any given point in time.

11. Professional Body Membership Support:

- a) To promote continuous professional development and engagement with the wider academic and professional community, the University provides financial assistance to faculty members for obtaining memberships in recognized professional bodies.
- b) Faculty members on rolls who have completed a minimum of twelve (12) months of continuous service with the University at the time of application shall be eligible for reimbursement of membership fees, subject to a maximum limit of ₹10,000 per calendar year.
- c) The approved reimbursement amount shall be processed and disbursed at the closing of the Financial Year.
- d) Faculty members who are serving their notice period shall not be eligible to apply for or avail any new membership reimbursement under this provision.

Submission Window: To avail yourself of this benefit, formal requests for reimbursement or assistance must be submitted between **January and February** of the calendar year concerned.

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12. Incentives for securing Extramural Funding:

Incentive Disbursement structure for faculty members on rolls:

Grant Amount Secured	Incentive to PI	Incentive to Co-PIs	Disbursement Schedule
Up to ₹5 lakhs	₹5,000 (one-time)	₹2,500 (shared, if number is more than one)	After release of grant by funding agency
₹5 – ₹10 lakhs	₹10,000	₹5,000 (shared, if number is more than one)	After 50% project fund utilization
₹10 – ₹50 lakhs	3% of total grant	1.5% (shared among Co-PIs)	In two installments (initiation and completion)
Above ₹50 lakhs	5% of total grant	2.5% (shared among Co-PIs)	In three installments (start, mid-term, end)

12.1 Overhead Utilization: Any overhead charges received under externally funded projects shall be utilized exclusively for strengthening research infrastructure, facilities, and institutional research capabilities, in accordance with the financial norms of the University. The eligible grant amount shall exclude institutional overhead charges, administrative costs, or similar allocations meant for the University. Incentives shall be calculated only on the direct project cost allocated for research activities.

12.2 Reporting and Utilization Compliance: Faculty members shall submit all required project completion reports, financial statements, and utilization certificates as mandated by the funding agency and the University. Full disbursement of incentives shall be subject to submission and acceptance of these documents.

12.3 Use of Incentives: Incentives disbursed under this policy are intended to support professional development, research capability enhancement, and academic performance improvement of the faculty member.

Multi-Institutional Grants: In the case of collaborative or multi-institutional research projects, incentives shall be calculated only on the portion of the project funds allocated to NIIT University as per the sanctioned budget. Where the faculty member serves as Principal Investigator (PI) at NU, the incentive shall be computed based on the NU share of the project. In cases where the faculty member is a Co-Principal Investigator (Co-PI) in a project led by another institution, the incentive shall be determined proportionately based on the funds administered through NU.

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13. Proper Utilization of Funds

All grants, incentives, travel support, and other financial assistance provided under this policy shall be utilized strictly for the purpose for which they are sanctioned and in accordance with the financial and research integrity norms of the University.

13.1 Funding Misuse

Funding misuse shall include, but shall not be limited to:

- a) Utilization of funds for purposes other than those approved.
- b) Submission of false, fabricated, or inflated claims, bills, or documents.
- c) Misrepresentation of research outputs or achievements for obtaining incentives.
- d) Non-compliance with reporting requirements, utilization certificates, or project deliverables.
- e) Any act constituting research misconduct, including plagiarism, falsification, or fabrication of data.

13.2 Recovery of Funds

Where misuse or irregular utilization of funds is established, the University reserves the right to recover the amount so disbursed, in full or in part. Such recovery may be effected through adjustment against pending reimbursements, incentives, salary dues, or any other payments payable by the University as per the sole discretion of the University.

13.3 Recovery of Incentives

Incentives or financial benefits granted under this policy may be withdrawn or recovered if the associated research output is subsequently found to involve academic misconduct, predatory publication practices, misrepresentation, or violation of University policies.

13.4 Review and Determination

Any matter relating to funding misuse or misconduct shall be examined by the competent authority or a committee constituted by the University. The concerned individual shall be given an opportunity to present clarification before a decision is taken on the principles of natural justice.

13.5 Final Authority

The decision of the University in matters relating to funding misuse, recovery of funds, and clawback of incentives shall be final and binding.

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A blue ink handwritten signature, appearing to be a stylized 'Z' or 'J'.

